

WTO & IPR Relay Cell

Vide a Government Order in December 2012, the WTO & IPR Relay Cell which was formerly with Karnataka Council for Technological Upgradation (KCTU), was transferred to VTPC.

The Cell conducts a host of Capacity building Programmes for the benefit of stakeholders across the State encompassing industry, academia, Government and more, across the WTO and International trade landscape and the spectrum of Intellectual Property Rights (IPR). The IP tools comprise Patents, Trademarks, Copyrights, Industrial Designs and Semi-Conductor integrated layouts, Geographical Indications, Plant Variety Protection and Trade Secrets.

The broad topics around which awareness and training programs are conducted span contemporary topics having broad ramifications on WTO and IPR issues. The Cell disseminates information/knowledge on key aspects of IP Creation, IP Protection, IP Commercialisation, IP Search and IP Enforcement among others. The Cell also engages in facilitating launch of IP Cells across academic institutions for nurturing the IP fabric.

A **Geographical Indications (GI) Policy** was announced by the Government of Karnataka in May 2019 through which VTPC has been involved in providing thrust to GIs (an Intellectual Property tool) through key measures laid down in the Policy.